

ReceiptVault

Small Business Expense Tracker with Photo Capture

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Team: Team 7

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1. Product Vision

Before we talk about features and functions, we need to agree on one thing: what is this product actually for? Not the technical answer. The human one.

ReceiptVault is for the person who has been running their business entirely from their phone and their memory. The freelancer who mentally notes every expense and tells themselves they will log it later. The market trader who keeps receipts in a polythene bag. The small business owner who dreads tax season because they know the next few days will be spent reconstructing three months of spending from bank alerts and guesswork.

These people are not disorganized. They just never had a tool built for how they actually live and work. ReceiptVault is that tool. ReceiptVault exists so that running a small business never means losing track of where your money went. Snap. Tag. Report. Done.

Three things this vision means for every decision we make:

- Keep it fast. If something slows down the experience, it does not belong in this version. The promise is 10 seconds to log an expense. Everything bows to that.
- Keep it simple. Our users are not accountants. They should never have to Google what a word in our app means. Plain language everywhere.
- Keep it honest. When something saves, the user should know it saved. When something fails, the user should know why. No mystery, no guessing.

2. Product Overview

ReceiptVault is a mobile application built for small business owners and freelancers who need a fast, reliable way to track business expenses. The app allows users to snap a photo of any physical receipt or manually enter expense details. Every entry is automatically categorized, optionally tagged to a specific project or client, and stored securely in the cloud. Users can view spending dashboards, generate formatted expense reports, and export data — all from their phone.

3. Problem Statement

Small business owners and freelancers routinely lose track of their business expenses. Physical receipts are misplaced, phone galleries fill up with unorganized receipt photos, and there is no easy way to categorize, total, or report on spending. This becomes a critical problem at tax time when accurate records are required. Existing solutions are either too complex, too expensive, or not designed for the solo operator or small team context.

Core pain points this product addresses:

- Receipts are lost or forgotten before they can be recorded.
- No categorization system means no visibility into where money is going.
- No way to tie expenses to specific clients or projects for profitability tracking.
- No reporting tool means scrambling at tax time to reconstruct spending.
- Existing accounting tools are too heavy and complex for freelancers.

4. Goals & Objectives

Product Goals

- Make expense logging so fast (under 10 seconds) that users actually do it consistently.
- Give users a clear picture of their spending broken down by category, project, and time period.
- Let users generate a clean, professional expense report they can hand to an accountant or attach to an invoice.
- Store all data and receipt photos securely in the cloud so nothing is ever lost.

Success Metrics (MVP)

The following table defines what good looks like for each measurable goal. These are not estimates — they are the numbers the team is building toward.

What We Are Checking	What Good Looks Like	Why This Matters
How fast a new user logs their first expense	Within 60 seconds of signing up — no setup, no tutorial needed	If they cannot find it in a minute, they will not come back
How fast the core expense entry is	8 out of 10 entries completed in under 10 seconds	This is the whole promise. If this fails, the product fails
Receipt photo upload speed	Photo uploads in under 5 seconds without freezing the app	A slow or broken upload makes users distrust the app
Dashboard load speed	Opens in under 2 seconds on a regular phone connection	Nobody waits. A slow home screen kills daily habits

Getting to a PDF report	User reaches a finished report in 3 taps from the dashboard	Reports are why people stay. They should be easy to get to
Offline entries syncing	Every offline entry syncs within 30 seconds of reconnecting	Many of our users have patchy internet. This cannot fail them
Error handling	Every failure shows a clear message and a way to try again	Silence after a failed action destroys trust immediately

5. Target Users

The primary users of ReceiptVault are individuals who run their own business or work independently and need to track spending without a full accounting team.

User Type	Description	Primary Need
Freelancers	Designers, developers, writers, consultants billing clients	Track per-client expenses for invoicing
Sole Traders	Small shop owners, tradespeople, market sellers	Record daily expenses, prepare for tax filing
Small Business Owners	Teams of 1–5 people with mixed expense types	Category reporting + recurring expense management

6. Onboarding Flow

Every new user goes through a minimal onboarding flow designed to get them into the app and logging their first expense as fast as possible. No lengthy setup or configuration is required.

Returning Users — Login Screen

- Email and password login fields.
- Sign in with Google option.
- Sign in with Apple ID option.
- Forgot password link for account recovery.

New Users — Create Account

- A 'Create Account' link on the login screen opens a registration overlay (not a separate page).
- Registration fields: full name, email address, password.
- On successful account creation, user is taken directly to the Add Expense screen — not the dashboard.
- This puts the user immediately into the core action of the app without any additional setup steps.

- No category configuration or walkthrough screens required before logging a first expense.

Empty State — First Launch

After creating an account and reaching the dashboard for the first time (before any expenses are logged), the user sees a friendly empty state rather than a blank screen.

- Dashboard empty state: a short message explaining what ReceiptVault does and a prominent 'Add Your First Expense' button.
- Expense list empty state: message that reads 'No expenses yet — tap + to add one.'
- Search empty state: message that reads 'No results found. Try a different keyword or filter.'
- Reports empty state: message that reads 'No expenses in this date range to report on.'

7. Feature Requirements

7.1 Quick Expense Entry

Users can log an expense in under 10 seconds by selecting a category, typing an amount, and optionally adding a short note. This is the fastest path to recording a transaction and is designed for moments when the user is still at the point of purchase.

Requirements:

- Tap-to-select category buttons visible on the main add screen.
- Numeric keypad auto-opens for amount entry.
- Optional note field — user can skip this entirely.
- One-tap save that immediately stores the entry.
- Amount field validates input — non-numeric characters are rejected and the field shows an inline error.
- On successful save, a visible success confirmation is shown (e.g. a toast or checkmark) so the user knows the entry was stored without having to check.

7.2 Photo Receipt Capture

Users can attach a photo of the physical receipt to any expense entry. The photo is uploaded to Supabase Storage and displayed alongside the expense record so users always have a digital copy of their proof of purchase.

Requirements:

- Camera integration to capture a receipt photo directly in-app.
- Option to upload from photo gallery instead of taking a new photo.
- Photo stored in Supabase Storage under the user's account (1GB free tier).
- Photo thumbnail shown in the expense detail view.
- Photo is permanently linked to its expense entry — deleting the entry also removes the photo.
- Upload happens in the background and does not block the user from saving the expense entry.

- A loading indicator is shown while the photo is uploading so the user knows it is in progress.
- If the upload fails due to a network issue, the app shows a clear error message and offers a retry option.

7.3 Category System

Every expense must be assigned to a category. The app ships with a predefined set of categories covering the most common small business expense types. Users can also create their own custom categories.

Predefined Categories:

- Transport
- Food & Meals
- Office Supplies
- Software & Subscriptions
- Rent & Utilities
- Marketing & Advertising
- Miscellaneous

Requirements:

- All predefined categories available at app launch with no setup required.
- User can create, rename, and delete custom categories.
- Category is a required field — expense cannot be saved without one.
- Categories shown as icon-labelled tiles for fast selection.

7.4 Project & Client Tagging

Users can tag any expense to a specific project or client. This enables per-project expense tracking, which is essential for freelancers who need to measure how much they spend on each client engagement.

Requirements:

- Users can create and name projects or clients freely.
- Tagging is optional — expenses without a project tag are recorded under 'General'.
- Users can filter their expense list by project to see all costs tied to one client.
- Project totals are surfaced in the monthly dashboard.

7.5 Dashboard

The dashboard is the home screen after login. It gives users an at-a-glance view of their rolling 30-day spending with key visual summaries and actionable insights.

Requirements:

- Dashboard defaults to a rolling 30-day window — showing spend from 30 days ago up to today, regardless of calendar month boundaries.
- Total spend for the active 30-day window displayed prominently at the top.

- Pie chart showing the percentage breakdown of spend by category within the active window.
- Bar chart showing daily spending trend within the active window.
- Insight card: top spending category for the active period (e.g. 'Your highest spend this period is Transport').
- Insight card: quick comparison showing whether total spend is up or down vs the previous 30-day window.
- Quick shortcut to add a new expense from the dashboard.
- Period selector to adjust or browse different date ranges from the dashboard.

7.6 Expense Report Generator

Users can generate a formatted expense report for any date range. The report is exported as a PDF file that can be saved, shared, or emailed to an accountant.

Requirements:

- User selects a custom date range (e.g., a full quarter, a financial month).
- Report contains: date, description, category, project tag, and amount for each expense.
- Report shows category subtotals and a grand total.
- PDF is generated using jsPDF and downloadable directly from the app.
- Report includes the user's name and the selected date range in the header.
- User can choose whether to include receipt images in the exported PDF report.
- User can customize which columns or sections appear in the report before generating.

7.7 Search & Filter

Requirements:

- Search bar that queries expense notes and descriptions by keyword.
- Filter by category (single or multiple).
- Filter by date range using a calendar picker.
- Filter by amount range (e.g., expenses above a set amount).
- Filter by project or client tag.
- Filters can be combined (e.g., 'Software' category + last 30 days).
- Default sort order is latest first (most recent expense at the top).
- A 'Reset Filters' option is always visible when any filter is active, clearing all filters in one tap.

7.8 Recurring Expense Support

Users can mark an expense as recurring. The app will auto-populate that expense on its scheduled date each month, so fixed costs like rent, subscriptions, or retainer payments are never missed.

Requirements:

- Toggle to mark any expense as recurring when creating or editing it.

- Recurrence frequency options: monthly (primary), weekly.
- Recurring entries auto-create on the correct date.
- User receives an in-app notification when a recurring expense is due.
- User can pause or delete a recurring rule at any time.
- Recurring expense behaviour is controlled by a user preference in the Settings page: users choose between 'Auto-save' (entry is saved automatically on the due date) or 'Confirm before saving' (app sends a notification and waits for the user to approve before logging the entry).
- The default preference on first launch is 'Confirm before saving' — the safer option for accuracy.
- Users can change this preference at any time from Settings.

7.9 CSV Export

In addition to PDF reports, users can export their full expense history as a CSV file. This is designed for users who use accounting software like QuickBooks, Wave, or Xero.

Requirements:

- Export full expense history or a filtered date range.
- CSV columns: Date, Amount, Category, Project, Note, Receipt Attached (Y/N).
- File downloads to device storage or can be shared via share sheet.

7.10 Year-over-Year Comparison

Users can compare spending for any given month against the same month in the previous year. This helps identify spending trends and plan budgets more accurately.

Requirements:

- Available from the dashboard — accessible via a 'Compare' button.
- Side-by-side view: this month's total vs. same month last year.
- Category-level comparison shown as a grouped bar chart.
- Percentage change highlighted (positive = more spent, negative = saved).

8. Feature Priority

With limited time and a full feature list, this section defines what gets built first, what can follow, and what is not being touched in this version.

Must Build — the product does not exist without these

Feature	Why it cannot wait
Quick expense entry	This is the whole product. Everything else is built around this one action.
Categories	Without categories there is nothing to organize, nothing to report on.

Photo receipt capture	The reason most users will choose ReceiptVault over anything else.
Dashboard with spending view	Users need to see their data at a glance or the app feels pointless.
PDF report export	This is the moment ReceiptVault proves its value. Cannot be an afterthought.
Login and account security	No authentication means no data safety. Non-negotiable.
Offline mode	Our users live in the real world with real connectivity problems.
Empty states and error messages	A blank screen or a silent crash will make users delete the app immediately.

Should Build — important but we can launch without them

Feature	Why it matters but can follow
Project and client tagging	Freelancers really need this but the app still works without it on day one.
Search and filters	Useful once a user has built up a history of expenses.
Recurring expenses	Great for rent and subscriptions. Not urgent on first launch.
CSV export	Helpful for users on accounting software. Most users will not need it immediately.
Year-over-year comparison	Planned feature — will be introduced once users have sufficient expense history built up.

Not Now — save for later versions

Feature	Why it waits
Custom report settings	The basic report already solves the problem. Customization comes later.
AI receipt scanning	Too complex and too unreliable for handwritten receipts at this stage.
Bank or card integration	Requires partnerships and compliance work well beyond MVP scope.
Multi-currency support	One currency keeps the first version clean and focused.
Team accounts and admin roles	ReceiptVault is for solo operators. Teams are a different product entirely.

9. User Flow Diagrams

The following three diagrams show the journey a user takes through the three most important actions in the app. They are designed to be read alongside the feature requirements in Section 7 and show the exact screens and decisions a user moves through.

Flow 1 — Onboarding

What happens the very first time a user opens ReceiptVault. The design principle is zero friction — no tutorials, no setup screens, no configuration. A new user goes straight into the core action of adding an expense. The key decision in this flow is that when a new user creates an account, they land directly on the Add Expense screen, not the dashboard. This ensures the first thing they do is experience the product's core value before they have anything to look at on a dashboard.

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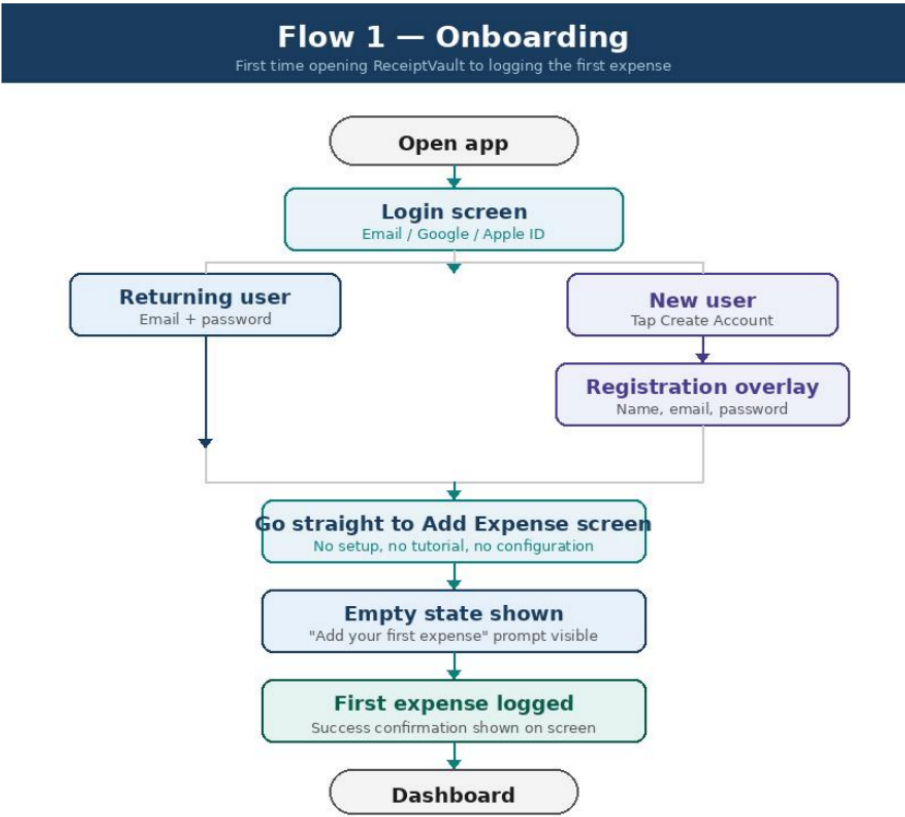


Figure 1 Onboarding flow: first app open to first expense logged

Figure 1 — Onboarding flow: first app open to first expense logged

Flow 2 — Core Expense Entry

The most important flow in the entire product. This is what users do every single day. The target is under 10 seconds from tapping Add Expense to seeing the confirmation that the entry was saved. The optional steps — adding a note, attaching a photo, tagging to a project — are clearly marked and completely skippable. A user who just needs to log an amount and a category should never be forced through extra steps to do it.

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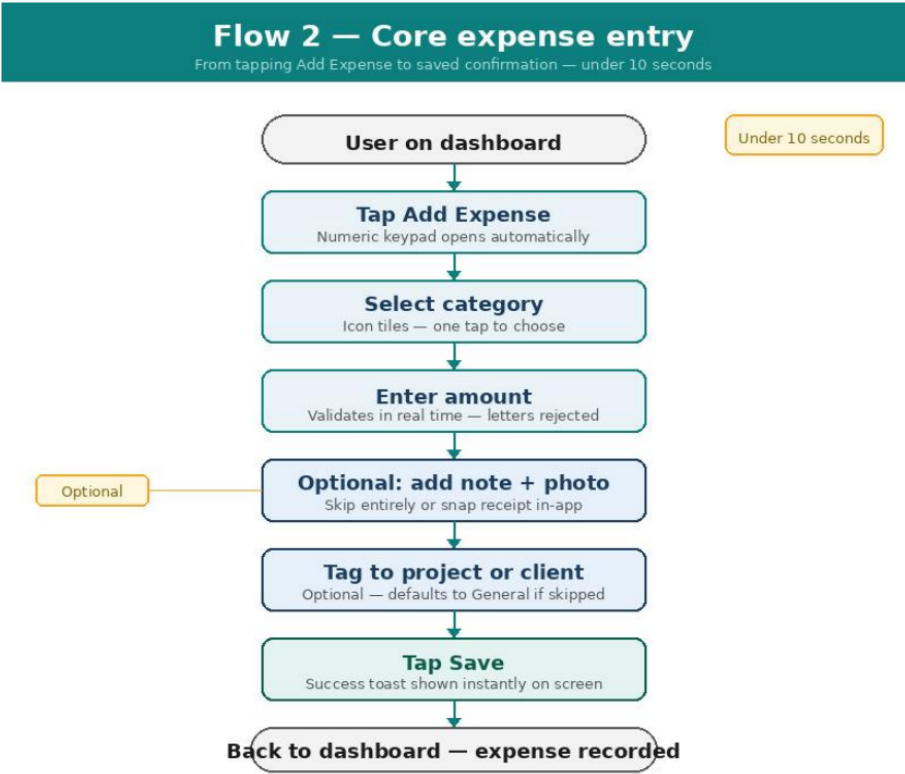


Figure 2 Core expense entry flow: tap to confirmation in under 10 seconds

Figure 2 — Core expense entry flow: tap to confirmation in under 10 seconds

Flow 3 — Report Generation

This is the moment ReceiptVault proves its value. A user who can generate a clean, professional expense report in three taps has experienced everything the product promises. This flow was designed specifically to meet that three-tap target. The optional settings step — choosing whether to include receipt photos or

customize report columns — does not interrupt the main flow. A user who wants a quick report taps three times and is done. A user who wants more control has the option without it being forced on them.

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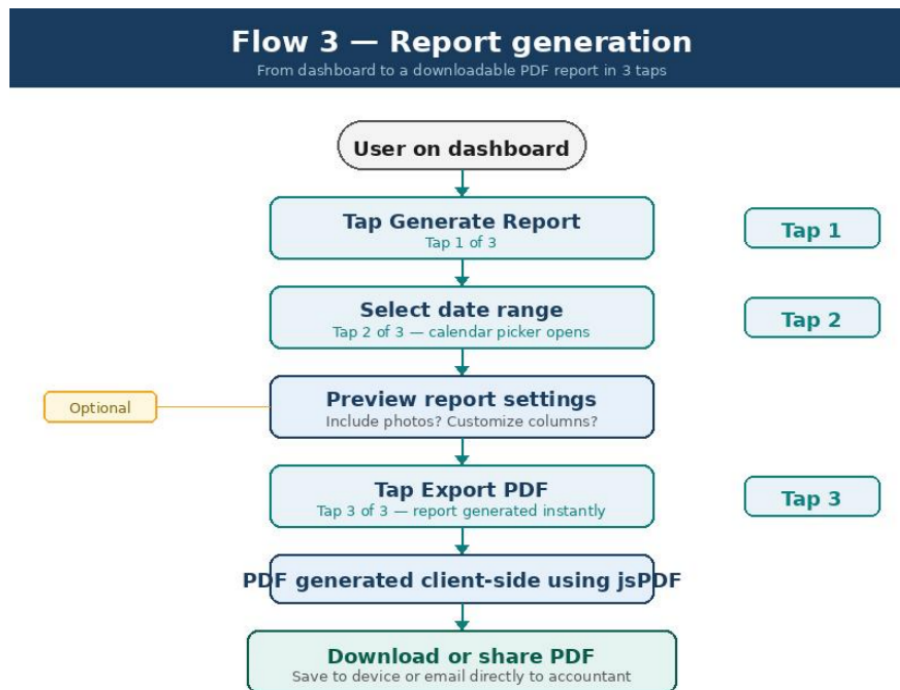


Figure 3 Report generation flow: dashboard to downloaded PDF in 3 taps

Figure 3 — Report generation flow: dashboard to downloaded PDF in 3 taps

10. Use Case Scenario

Capturing and Tracking a Business Expense

The following scenario illustrates the primary user flow from real-life trigger to saved expense record.

Step 1 — Real-Life Trigger

Tolu, a freelance designer, just paid for transportation after a client meeting. She wants to record the expense immediately so she doesn't forget it.

Step 2 — Quick Expense Entry

She opens the app and taps 'Add Expense'. She selects the Transport category, enters the amount (e.g. 3,500), and optionally adds a note: 'Client meeting – Ikeja'. The whole thing takes under 10 seconds.

Step 3 — Attach Receipt (Optional)

She snaps a photo of the receipt. The app uploads it in the background while she continues using the app. The receipt is linked to the expense entry.

Step 4 — Tag to Client

She selects a project tag: ABC Startup. Now every naira spent on this client is trackable in one place.

Step 5 — Save

She taps Save. The entry is stored instantly and a success confirmation appears on screen so she knows it went through. She doesn't need to check again or tap twice.

End of Month

Tolu opens the dashboard, sees her total spend by category, and generates a clean PDF expense report for the month — no scrambling through receipts or bank alerts.

11. Technical Stack

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Database	Supabase	Stores expenses, categories, projects, and user account data
File Storage	Supabase Storage	Stores receipt photo files (free tier: 1GB per account)
Authentication	Supabase Auth	Handles user sign-up, login, and session management
PDF Export	jsPDF	Generates formatted PDF expense reports client-side
Hosting	Vercel	Hosts and deploys the application

12. Non-Functional Requirements

Performance

- App should load the dashboard within 2 seconds on a standard mobile connection.
- Expense entry save action should complete in under 1 second.
- After a successful save, a visible confirmation (toast notification or checkmark) must appear on screen immediately so the user knows the action went through.
- Receipt photo upload should not block the UI — upload happens in the background.

- A progress indicator is shown during any save or upload action so the user always knows something is happening.

Security

- All user data is scoped to the authenticated user — no cross-user data access.
- Supabase Row Level Security (RLS) policies enforced on all database tables.
- Authentication managed via Supabase Auth with secure token handling.
- No sensitive financial data is stored in plain text.

Usability

- Core expense logging flow must be completable in under 10 seconds.
- App must work on both iOS and Android.
- All form inputs must validate in real time and display clear, inline error messages for invalid entries.
- All destructive actions (e.g. delete expense, remove receipt) must require a confirmation step.

Offline Mode

- Users can log expenses while offline — entries are queued locally on the device.
- When internet connection is restored, queued entries sync automatically to Supabase.
- If a sync conflict occurs (e.g. duplicate entry detected), the app keeps both entries and flags them for the user to review.
- The app shows a visible offline indicator in the UI when the device has no connection.

Scalability

- Database schema must support multiple user accounts independently.
- Storage usage per user is capped at 1GB on the free Supabase tier.
- When a user reaches 80% of their 1GB storage limit, the app shows a warning notification.
- When the limit is reached, new photo uploads are blocked and the user is informed clearly.
- Architecture should allow additional storage tiers or paid plans in future.

13. Out of Scope (MVP)

The following features are explicitly out of scope for the initial MVP build and should not be designed or developed until v1 is complete and validated:

- Bank account or credit card integration / automatic transaction import.
- Invoice creation or billing functionality.
- Multi-user team accounts or admin roles.
- AI-powered receipt scanning / OCR to auto-fill expense fields.

- Native iOS or Android desktop apps (web-first mobile experience for MVP).
- Multi-currency support.
- Budget limits or spending alerts.

14. Assumptions & Constraints

- The app is built as a mobile-first web app (not a native app) for MVP.
- Users have a stable internet connection for syncing and photo uploads.
- Supabase free tier (1GB storage, 500MB database) is sufficient for the MVP user load.
- PDF generation is handled client-side using jsPDF — no server-side rendering required.
- All users are individual accounts — shared team accounts are not in scope.

15. Resolved Decisions

The following questions were previously open and have now been formally decided by the team.

Question	Decision
Should the dashboard default to the current calendar month or a rolling 30-day window?	Rolling 30-day window. The dashboard always shows the last 30 days from today.
Is there a web (desktop) version of the app planned, or is this mobile-only?	Mobile app only. No web or desktop version is planned for this product.
Should recurring expense auto-entries require user confirmation before saving, or save automatically?	Hybrid approach. Users set their preference in Settings — either Auto-save or Confirm before saving. Default is Confirm before saving.

This PRD was prepared by Team 7 as part of a UI/UX Design Bootcamp Capstone Project. It is based solely on the project brief provided to the team and reflects the MVP scope as defined. All feature decisions are subject to change following stakeholder review.